



Prolific player: Australian batter Stuart Law cuts Dion Nash of New Zealand during the 1996 ODI World Cup quarterfinal. V. V. KRISHNAN

be even nicer if we snuck a win or two against Bangladesh.

The Impact Player and two-bouncer rule have been implemented in the Indian Premier League (IPL). What are your thoughts on those?

I like the two-bouncer rule. It is a real weapon if you have fast bowlers. That's one thing. This game, particularly the T20 format, is stacked in the batter's favour. The batter is not punished if he swings and misses; however, if a bowler oversteps, he or she must bowl another ball. Impact rule, I am not 100% convinced. Don't mess with the fabric of the game of cricket. I've seen it used in different parts of the world. Cricket isn't football, where you can sub three or four players. You cannot score 80 odd runs and then not do the fielding. And part of the game is, you know, you've got to be fit, you've got to be skilled, and you've got to show commitment to the team. And, generally, it's a 40-over game. It's not a 20-over game because you have to bat for 20

overs and field for 20 overs. I disagree with the Impact Player rule.

How do you envision USA cricketers contributing to nurturing and developing cricket talent domestically and fostering increased interest in the sport among youth?

I'm sure there are people out there, kids watching or knowing the game of cricket. The one thing in this country is that not many people know about the game of cricket. When you mention cricket, they think about a mobile phone company. They might have seen their heroes from, you know, other worlds, but I reckon that if we play well and put up something inspirational on the cricket field in the World Cup, it'll trigger something in young kids in the USA. So every player, coach, and administrator has a role to play in increasing cricket's profile in this country, and the way we can do that is for players to talk positively about the game. And, hopefully, on the cricket field, we can show them how far it can go. So everyone's got a part to play, not just certain individuals. But we will find a cult hero from the USA in this World Cup. I guarantee we'll find one that fans will jump on and love. It might be that they become the face of USA cricket.

Do you perceive a trend emerging regarding increased injuries among cricket players compared to your generation?

I think everyone's a little bit more aware of their bodies nowadays. If we had a slight hamstring problem, a calf problem, or a broken or cracked finger, we could still get the right way of playing, but it was a bit uncomfortable. Our senior players told us to just get on with them. If I went into an MRI scanning machine and had my whole body scanned, I'd come in with about 45 injuries. Cricket's not easy on the body. Everyone says, 'Oh, you just stand there', but that's not the case. For a fast bowler, it's the most unnatural movement for a human body to go through. So, if you don't always get it right, there will be problems. I've got to be careful what I say here because the sports science that has come into the game was designed to prevent injuries. They haven't. The injuries are still there. They might not be as severe as they possibly could have been, but they're still there. So they haven't prevented them, but they have stopped the player from playing earlier. Otherwise, you would have kept playing through back in the day, and it would have been career-ending. So, they stopped them playing earlier, and then they